E1iz@b3ths_D1g1t@_N0t3b00k_3

This week, we toss out the idea that digitization and digital creations are simply archived copies of the documents they seek to preserve/present. Rather, choices are made at each step of the process of digitization/digital creation that shape how the final product exists and the impact it has; the digital methods and platforms used impact how something can exist and work upon the world.
Digital works are particular versions of the original text with particular differences, not a replacement.

Notes on digitization from class:

We reject:

- idea that digitization is preservation, and we can just throw everything else out
  - if a scan is the only copy, not copyrighted, transformative
  - why ai orgs buying all books and destroying them after a scan
- idea that scan in super high resolution is an archival copy
  - many do capture almost all of the visual data on the document... but still there exist choices that differentiate the digital from the original
  - and what of the material data that cannot be digitized?
  - even the first decision to scan something depends on the physicality of the object and and on the technology available (the digital object)
  - non-choices like the amount of light that can be used for a given tool also shape the final digital work
    if we made the digital physical again... is it the same as it was? Do the choices we make when we digitize something not affect what is possible for the next digitization
- metadata can be explained in a number of way - a set of terms in metadata that have been hammered out through conferences... the terms of your metadata decides how your object can speak and interact (be found etc)
  - what about being remixable though?

"Q i-jtb the Raven" Taking Dirty OCR Seriously Notes

- text mining relies not on texts themselves, but on texts as remediated by mass digitization (labour intensive, tech intensive, economically determined process)
- OCR-derived text underlies our searches
- Kirschenbaum and Werner call for the "perspectives of book historians … on the large-scale digitization efforts underway at such places such as Google Books, the Internet Archive,

HathiTrust, Gallica, and other institutions that are actively aiming to make print resources available as digital objects."
    - uneven, unclear metadata quality
    - 2D representation, flat
    - single-copy digitization (I wonder if this sort of canonizes one particular version, without necessarily a tremendous amount of thought as to why)
      -> How can we digitize bibliographically to account for "sources, technologies, and social realities of their creation" so people can discuss and critique?
    - Digitization is part of that bibliography, rather than separate
- the e-book, Galey shows, is "a complex transaction of electronic signals, material inscriptions, and cultural codes" which we interpret through "layers and layers of digital tools and interfaces.
- often do not *see* the digital object, but surrogate of the print object from which it is derived. Why are we citing and discussing digital objects as if discovered through analog means? removed role of the web interfaces, human labor, and algorithmic search technologies that shape what can(t) find
    - ""We still tend to think of computers as physical machines rather than the software that makes them go … we think of the iPad, but not the Safari browser that comes on every iPad"
- Errorful OCR influences influences our research, inhibiting, for instance, comprehensive search.
    - correcting costs time and money
- copes letters and words from form rather than by sense
- while human compositors and correctors typically did recognize the words they composed, their processes could be more automatic than we might countenance
- Mak describes the layers of a digitization's image, text data, metadata, and interface, "as palimpsests" altering each other, "a particular synthesis of traditional and emergent technologies" that are "challenging to locate for scholarly analysis."
- "OCR-derived text so rarely *can* stand in for the texts from which it derives" surrogacy is myth
- such models also flatten our understanding of digitizations, encouraging misrecognitions that stymie both computational and bibliographic thinking. When the "It" of an interface refers only to a print edition, it reinforces codexical thinking in the midst of a digital edition rich with machine reading possibilities
- If the digitized version of a text is a new, clearly-distinct edition, then it cannot stand as "one representative copy" for all the physical copies of its print original.52 A "'surrogate first' policy that restricts access to print copy" makes no sense when the digital edition cannot be considered a surrogate... but argues surrogacy not a good way of understanding anywys.

This a new edition impacted by its method of digitization, sources, the choices of digitizers, and context of production

- funding and time limitations lead to digitization errors... shaped by funding and thereby by the economic and politcal conditions in which produced. Some places' project sunderfunded and others not at all
- '" A historical object in a large scale digital archive evidences not only the time period of its print original and its online present. It witnesses also to cultural and scholarly modes of transmission that bridge the period of the historical object's creation and our experience of its digitized editions."
- bringing out the bibliographies of sources *forefronts their createdness*
- not a technical challenge, but a challenge of imagination.

‘Q i-jtb the Raven’: Taking Dirty OCR Seriously Blog Post

- provides a bibliography of own text, showing its evolution from a blog post, and what it does not capture due to time restrictions

Sparrow, T., Bain, K., Kimber, M. and Wilson, A.S. 2024 Visualising Heritage

- completed for Grand Junction Railway (GJR), Stephenson's Roundhouse (the world's first Railway Roundhouse), and Curzon (Principal) Building
    - used scalar approaches to terrestrial and airborne capture, from the object scale to landscapes, including complex cityscapes
    - long-range terrestrial laser scans obtained using a FARO X330 laser scanner
    - mobile mapping using a GeoSLAM Zeb Horizon
    - a total of 667 images in RAW format were captured for the Grand Junction Railway Booking office, with a further 7,565 images captured for the Roundhouse
    - Terrestrial scan data and structure-from-motion photogrammetry were also used during the excavation of the former Park Street Cemetery to document brick-lined vaults and exemplars of earthen graves
- allows for an analysis of changes over time as compare original plans to scans of buildings
- methods of creating engaging models and visuals to inform and influence wider public and city/national projects (HS2 Phase One professionals here). richly interactive
    - Stephenson's roundhouse reburied to protect archeological remains
- scope restricted by funding and time
- data deposited with the Archaeology Data Service in York

Handwriting Recognition Roundup + Reflections

- has gemini 3.0 solved handwriting recognition?

- "doing this better than the best human-trained models and even better than actual humans trained in paleography at a graduate level."
  -> I struggle with this article because I worry that it describes how Gemini is interacting with the text like how a human would, but AI doesnt *really* think
  ex. Humphries "describes testing Gemini's ability to read and reason through complex early modern ledger books" ... but is AI really "reasoning" when it follows a pattern?
  ex. "to argue mathematically and ethically that my prompt was factually incorrect."... is it really making an ethical argument? What do we mean by that?
- "It allows human beings to focus their time on the important, profound work of understanding another human being, rather than staring at a curlicue to grasp if it's an L or an I." This I can understand
- "But now that AI can read handwriting—presumably at scale—perhaps we should revive the dream of putting *everything* online. Not just the already-famous collections, not just materials in major languages, not just the stuff that's easy to process. Everything."
  WARNING WARNING BEEP BEEP BEEP! Maybe not everything should be transcribed and put online!
- "we still dont fully understand what it means to have AI as an intermediary between researchers and primary sources." -> would need to include this in bibliography of a project...
- but can we really disregard the ethical cost? Is this the position we should take?

_LEARNING OCR!

Pre-tutorial class notes

- OCR is not something you do and it's done. Need to inject semantic info into it to be useful
  - comes out of mechanics aimed towards supported partially sited people
  - devices for scanning light, which can be used to scan for numbers -> how we got automatic cheque readers in 1950s
    - your computer learning the pattern of pixels for a 3 and for an E and lights up in their patterns
    - now can feed images... but images need to be cleaned up a lot to be read by the operating system
  - what we have now is a change not in what it's doing, but how much data it's familiar with and what it can do with it
    - Computer vision contest: a scholar finds that if she feeds it enough networks data, don't need to tell it in so much detail how to do to make something... it begins to know what to do
- network, input... can measure the distance between what system spits out as a cat and an actual image of cat.

        - measure the error and readjust things to get closer to reduce that error. Cycled over and over reducing the error, end up with a guess that is actually accepted by us. This is machine learning
        - can be used to image categorization and classification ... show it your target and it drops things through until it finds a close match
- for OCR, no longer a program with a find tuned model for everything, just need to feed it the info

Gwen's Presentation - Not Painful!

- a lot of errors and no formatting... goal is to make an ordered data set out of it so we can use it
    - context: splits up logically and gives information inside of each section in a more structured format
    - doesnt clean up text itself that much, just worried about formatting
        - still gonna be messy and wrong
- a lot of it using regular expressions
    - sort of looking for regularly used strings of text or formatting
        - in word if you try to find something, won't find if not exactly what you typed... BUT if you know what you're looking for, can write a regular expression that shows computer what shape of thing should look like
            - will know you're after the shape of a date for example, find 19-82 and 19-99
        - again, doesn't really clean up for you - looks for discrepancies and flagging them for you so you can change that yourself
- this exercise is a practice at doing this, but it is really messy

need to:

- clean up and add formatting so readable as a text file

process

1. download pdf
2. stick into pdf to textfile converter
    1. pdf files where text can be copied and pasted already have OCR done from the image of the text! if can't select the text, pdf just an image without OCR
3. use colab to write and run the code... first figure out how to get colab to read
    1. upload file into colab... "copy path"
    2. get colab to read the file with string of code referring to

-

4. importing
    1. telling python what to do by using the lego bricks in our tool set
        1. copy and pasating from tutorial
            1. import re = go get regular expression lego dot
            2. re. is pulling out compile brick in re.compile... the compile brick knows what to pull out
                1. regular expressions mix their flags in with the text youre going after.. hard, needs practice
                2. anytime you have the \ symbol, that's a flag for the regular expression
            3. charters = dict() is making a dictionary of lines so can access later
                1. also have fun bucket to hold the lines... nesting dolls
5. chunking up the text by page
    1. hard to know where the page breaks even are in OCR, get thrown off.
    2. but can use headings that seperate each page, using regular expressions
6. we are using a levenshtein distance. give it a number... lower the number is, the closer to the original text file it is. A measurement of similarity. want it to recognize strings that are close together as heading
7. reaching out to dr graham
    1. he helped get the original txt file that tutirial doesnt give you. can use wget to pull that file. now working with same ocr file as author (or a portion of it)
    .> ! is a bang specifically in collan
    !wget
8. have to use an r everywhere to get it to do what you want it toi
    1. writing a mini program to use as a variable so can use again and again
    2. not a solution you'd be likely to find yourself

at the top: gets used later
9. she then realizes needs to do the chunk of code at the top before she does the rest of it, to break things up onto chunks. Levenshtein distance
1. measures similarities and differences between words to try to find things that look the same (ex, cow and c0w but not c0w and smurrf)
10. changing roman numerals into arabic numbers
-> put all definitions at the top before we actually use anything
for example:

```
def rom2ar(rom):
roman_code = {'M': 1000, 'D":500, 'I': 1}
roman = roman.upper()
roman - list(roman)
```

roman.reverse() -> reverse roman string as this is order that arabic numerals work
decimal = [roman_codec[ch]] for ch in roman
result = 0

chunk timm

1. recto_lev_score = lev(line, HEADER WRITTEN HERE) - have to know the documents and their patterns to know what to put there. like know headers names
   creatres score for left hand page by feeding line from OCR and measuring how far it is from what should be

if recti_lev_score < 26 :
n +- 1
print (f"recto: {recto_lev_score}{line.strip()}")
else:
finishes loop

use 26 as small enough

fin = means putting in a bucket called fun
fin = open("\content\iput), 'r')
fin = open("out1.txt", 'w')
GScriba - fin.readlines ()

PPRINT MEANS PRETTY PRINT
PPRINT(CHARTERS)
means print the charters so easier to read

- then can use the html to print is as readable text. gives us a chunk of code for this and we can drop it into the browser to give us something readablE

DESCRIBING THE PATTERN OF THE WORK YOU WANT TO DO IS MORE IMPORTANT THAN WORKING OUT THE CODE

- a more important skill than knowimg the syntax precisely
- need to be able to read through code to understand flow and steps in process.. but if can describe pattern and what you are after in a way that makes sense, you can find success

DO NOT DO NOT DO NOT DO NOT USE THIS METHOD ON SENSITIVE INFORMATION WE ARE USING A SERVICE FROM A COMPANY CALLED GROQ (NOT ELON'S) TO ACCESS OCR

- THE GROQ CLOUD
  - A HARDWARE ARRANGEMENT THAT GIVES RESULTS FAST

- BUT YOU STILL GIVING INFO TO THIS ORG, SHOULD USE SOMETHING THAT JUST LIVES SOLELY ON YOUR COMPUTER